



GAME RULES

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PART 7: THE BATTLEFIELD

OGÓLNE

7.1 LINE OF SIGHT

Every shot, every ability, and every order that requires a clear view of the target follows the same process. Line of Sight determines what a model can see and, by extension, what it can shoot at.

StarCraft: The Miniatures Game uses a 2D Line of Sight (LoS) system. All Line of Sight checks are resolved from a top-down perspective, looking directly down at the battlefield from above.

To determine whether an acting model can see a target, trace an imaginary straight line from **any part** of the acting model's base to **any part** of the target model's base.

If the line does not pass through any Blocking Terrain (any terrain piece with an Effective Size of 1 or greater - see Part 11), the target is Visible. No further checks are required.

If the line passes through Blocking Terrain, the target is not automatically hidden. Check the Cover rules (Part 7.1.1) to determine whether the terrain actually blocks Line of Sight. Terrain that intersects the trace but does not meet the requirements for Full Cover or Direct Cover does not block Line of Sight. The target remains Visible.

For Line of Sight purposes, a terrain piece's footprint is defined by its physical base or, if it has no base, the outermost edges of its solid structure viewed from above. Unless players agree otherwise during Battlefield Setup, gaps, windows, doorways, and open interiors within the footprint **do block** the Line of Sight.

A terrain opening may be passable for movement without counting as open for Line of Sight (see Part 4.6 for Gap Clearance rules).

Players must agree during Battlefield Setup on the footprint of each terrain

piece and on which openings, if any, count as passable gaps for movement.

Designer's note: Our game uses a top-down Line of Sight method rather than precise measurement from the model's eye. This prevents disputes over posture, slouching torsos, and weapon placement. It also ensures terrain interacts correctly regardless of model posture or base design. The downside is a slight loss of cinematic feel, but it is well worth it for speed and balance.

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7.1.1 Cover

Terrain pieces may block the Line of Sight between models. A terrain piece provides Cover in one of two ways:

Full Cover: A terrain piece blocks Line of Sight if its Effective Size (Part 7.1.2) is **equal** to or **greater** than the Effective Size of **both** the attacker and the Target. Neither model can see over the terrain - Line of Sight is blocked.

Direct Cover: If the Line of Sight trace passes through a terrain piece, and either the attacker or the target is Within 1" of that terrain, the Line of Sight between them is blocked, provided the terrain piece's Effective Size is equal to or greater than the Effective Size of the model that is Within 1".

Each terrain piece is assessed for Cover independently. Terrain pieces do not combine their Effective Size or proximity. If no single terrain piece meets the requirements for Full Cover or Direct Cover, Line of Sight is not blocked, regardless of how many terrain pieces the trace passes through.

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In this example, a player checks Line of Sight from a Goliath (Size 3) to a Unit of five Marines (Size 2) through a ruined wall (Size 2). The wall is too short to block the Goliath's view entirely - Full Cover fails. However, two Marines are Within 1" of the wall. Because the wall's **Size** equals the Marines' **Size**, the Line of Sight to and from those two Marines is blocked - they are not Visible to the Goliath, and the Goliath is not Visible to them. The remaining three Marines are too far from the wall and are Visible normally.

ELEVATION DEAD ZONE

If a model on HIGH GROUND (Size 3+) draws Line of Sight to a model at GROUND LEVEL that is Within 1" of the base of the same terrain piece, Line of Sight is blocked. This applies in both directions - neither model can see the other.

CLOSE QUARTERS

If both models are Within 1" of the same terrain piece and Within 3" of each other, Direct Cover, Elevation Dead Zone do not apply. Resolution Sight normally using the standard trace (Part 7.1).

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In this example: a Marine on HIGH GROUND checks Line of Sight to a Zergling at GROUND LEVEL. The Zergling is Within 1" of the base of the same terrain piece the Marine is standing on, but the two models are more than 3" apart. The Zergling is too close to the foot of the cliff to be seen from above - Line of Sight is blocked. This works in both directions - the Zergling cannot see the Marine above it either. If the two models were Within 3" of each other, Close Quarters would apply, and standard Line of Sight rules would be used instead.

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7.1.2 Verticality and Effective Size

When a model stands on top of a terrain piece (such as HIGH GROUND):

Effective Size is equal to the model Size plus the terrain Size.

EXAMPLE: A Marine (Size 2) on HIGH GROUND (Size 4) has an Effective Size of 6. He can see over Size 5 walls that would blind him at GROUND LEVEL.

Abathur's TIP: HIGH GROUND is a powerhouse on the battlefield. When a Unit is on terrain with a Size of 3 or 4, the Effective Size of that Unit goes through the roof, letting it peer over barriers that would block the Line of Sight of Units on lower ground. The best position for ranged support is to utilise HIGH GROUND, as you can rain down fire from above. The downside, of course, is that Units on HIGH GROUND are exposed to just about everything, so only put Units there if they can handle whatever is coming their way. Ranged specialists with good Armour or Evade stats are the ones that really shine from HIGH GROUND, but Units with lower stats should remain on the ground if they want to stay hidden.

Top-Down Perspective: Only terrain pieces that rise vertically between the two models' positions (as viewed from above) can block the shot. The horizontal surface a model stands on does not obstruct the top-down trace.

Stacking Terrain: When a terrain piece is set on HIGH GROUND or MID GROUND, its Effective Size increases in the same way as a model's - it gains the Size of the terrain it stands on.

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In this example, a Marauder (Size 2) is on HIGH GROUND (Size 3), giving it an Effective Size of 5. A ruined wall (Size 2) is also on HIGH GROUND (Size 3), giving it an Effective Size of 5. Because they have the same Effective Size, the Marauder cannot see over the ruined wall. The Roach (Size 2) on GROUND LEVEL cannot make a Line of Sight with the Marauder because the ruined wall (Effective Size 5) blocks it. However, the Hydralisk at GROUND LEVEL can make a Line of Sight with the Marauder because there is no obstacle in the way.

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In this example, the Goliath (Size 3) stands on HIGH GROUND (Size 4), increasing the Goliath's Effective Size to 7. The wall (Size 2) set on HIGH GROUND has an Effective Size of 6.

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7.1.3 High Ground Cover

If all models of a Unit are standing on HIGH GROUND (Size 3 or larger terrain) with any part of their bases, the Unit becomes eligible to make an **Evade Roll** against all **Ranged Attacks** originating from a lower elevation. The attack originates from the lower elevation if at least one model of the attacking Unit isn't standing on the HIGH GROUND with any part of their base.

Exception: Flying Units never benefit from HIGH GROUND Cover, regardless of their physical position on the battlefield. **Ranged Attacks** made by Flying Units never originate from the lower elevation, regardless of their position on the battlefield.

DESIGNER'S NOTE: HIGH GROUND is already a strong position on the battlefield, thanks to the bonus from Effective Size and Line of Sight. However, a Unit occupying HIGH GROUND is also more Visible to almost everything on the table, creating a weakness. The Evade Roll provided to Units occupying HIGH GROUND reflects the defensive benefit of being in a raised position. It is more difficult to fire uphill. This provides players with a strong reason to occupy a raised position, aside from the Line of Sight bonus.

7.1.4 Flying Units and Cover

When checking **Line of Sight** to or from a Flying model, ignore the Full Cover rule.

Direct Cover and the Elevation Dead Zone rules still apply.

For Cover purposes, treat a Flying model's Effective Size as higher than

the Effective Size of any terrain piece on the table.

Because of this, terrain can never provide Full Cover against a Flying model and can never provide Direct Cover to a Flying model as the model is Within 1" of terrain. However, a Flying model still obeys any Direct Cover or Elevation Dead Zone rule that applies to the other model in the attack.

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LOS and COVER SUMMARY TABLE:

LINE OF SIGHT - CORE RULES

Rule / Case	Result	Detail
BASE SYSTEM (<u>\$7.1</u>)		
LoS method	• 2D TOP-DOWN	Trace a straight line from any part of the attacker's base to any part of the target's base, viewed from directly above.
Measurement	• HORIZONTAL ONLY	Vertical height never factors into Range or LoS checks.
Trace does NOT pass through <u>Blocking Terrain</u>	✓ <u>VISIBLE</u>	No further checks required.
Trace passes through <u>Blocking Terrain</u>	◆ CHECK <u>COVER</u>	Apply Full <u>Cover</u> or Direct <u>Cover</u> rules (<u>\$7.1.1</u>). Target may still be <u>Visible</u> .
Terrain footprint definition	• OUTER EDGE	Gaps, windows, and doorways inside a terrain piece do block LoS.
<u>EFFECTIVE SIZE</u> & ELEVATION (<u>\$7.1.2</u>)		

Model on HIGH GROUND

• MODEL +
TERRAIN SIZE

E.g. Marine (Size 2) on HIGH GROUND (Size 4) = Effective Size 6.

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Terrain piece on HIGH GROUND

• TERRAIN +
TERRAIN SIZE

The same stacking rule applies to terrain set on elevated surfaces.

Model at GROUND LEVEL

- NO BONUS

Effective Size = model's own Size characteristic only.

ELEVATION DEAD ZONE (§7.1.1)

HIGH GROUND model traces LoS to the GROUND LEVEL model Within 1" of the terrain base

✗ LoS
BLOCKED

Applies in both directions. Neither model can see the other.

Close Quarters override (both Within 1" of the same terrain AND Within 3" of each other)

✓ LoS
RESTORED

Standard LoS rules apply. Dead Zone is ignored. Works in both directions.

COVER - FULL DECISION TABLE



Cover Type

Condition

LoS Result

Ref

FULL COVER

Full Cover

Terrain Effective Size $\geq$
Effective Size of BOTH attacker
AND target

✗ LoS
BLOCKED

\$7.1.1

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DIRECT COVER

Direct Cover
- (attacker
behind
terrain)

LoS trace passes through
terrain, AND attacker is Within
1" of that terrain AND terrain
Eff. Size $\geq$ attacker Eff. Size

⚠ Close Quarters exception: if
both models are Within 1" of
the same terrain piece AND
Within 3" of each other, this
rule is bypassed - use standard
LoS instead.

✗ LoS
BLOCKED
(unless
Close
Quarters)

\$7.1.1

Direct Cover
- (target
behind
terrain)

LoS trace passes through
terrain, AND target is Within
1" of that terrain AND terrain
Eff. Size $\geq$ target Eff. Size

⚠ Close Quarters exception: if
both models are Within 1" of
the same terrain piece AND
Within 3" of each other, this
rule is bypassed - use standard
LoS instead.

✗ LoS
BLOCKED
(unless
Close
Quarters)

\$7.1.1

NO COVER / VISIBLE DESPITE TERRAIN

Terrain too
small

Full Cover fails, AND neither
model is Within 1" of terrain
(Direct Cover fails)

✓ VISIBLE

\$7.1.1

Multiple
small terrain
pieces

Trace passes through several
pieces, but no single piece
satisfies Full or Direct Cover

✓ VISIBLE

\$7.1.1

Model not
Within 1" of

Trace passes through terrain;
Direct Cover proximity

✓ VISIBLE

\$7.1.1

terrain condition not met for that model

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HIGH GROUND COVER -EVADE BONUS

HIGH GROUND Cover ALL models of defending Unit are Wholly Within HIGH GROUND (Size 3+), AND at least one attacking model is NOT Wholly Within HIGH GROUND ◆ E VADE ROLL GRANTED \$7.1.3

Attacker is also on HIGH GROUND All attacking models are Wholly Within HIGH GROUND ✕ NO EVADE BONUS \$7.1.3

FLYING UNITS

Full Cover When checking Line of Sight to or from a Flying model, ignore the Full Cover rule. ✓ VISIBLE - NO COVER \$7.1.1

Direct Cover - target Flying Units' Effective Size is always higher than the Effective Size of any terrain piece on the table. ✓ VISIBLE - NO COVER \$7.1.1

Direct Cover -attacker LoS trace passes through terrain, AND target is Within 1" of that terrain AND terrain Eff. Size ≥ target Eff. Size ✕ LoS BLOCKED (unless Close Quarters) \$7.1.1

HIGH GROUND Cover Flying Units never benefit from HIGH GROUND Cover, regardless of their physical position on the battlefield. ✕ NO EVADE BONUS \$7.1.3

IMPORTANT: Each terrain piece is evaluated independently for Cover. Pieces do not combine Effective Size or proximity - one piece must satisfy the full condition on its own. | GRASS unlike other Size 2 terrain, does not block movement but does block Line of Sight.

BLOCKING TERRAIN & ELEVATION - QUICK REFERENCE

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Size	Blocking?	Passable?	Elevation	How to reach / rule
Size 0	✗ NOT BLOCKING	✓ PASS FREELY	<u>GROUND LEVEL</u>	Standing on the battlefield
Size 1	✓ BLOCKING	✓ PASS FREELY	<u>MID GROUND</u>	Horizontal terrain Size 1-2
Size 2	✓ BLOCKING	✗ CANNOT PASS	<u>HIGH GROUND</u>	Horizontal terrain Size 3+
Size 2 - <u>GRASS</u>	✓ BLOCKING	◆ PASS (destroyed)		
Size 3+	✓ BLOCKING	✗ CANNOT PASS	Change elevation	Must use an <u>ACCESS POINT</u>
			<u>Flying Units</u>	Ignore terrain; <u>move</u> point-to-point

7.2 ENGAGEMENT AND ENGAGEMENT RANGE



The Engagement Range extends 1" horizontally from any model's base. When two Enemy models are Within 1" of each other, they are Engaged - locked in close combat.

Unless stated otherwise, a Unit cannot end any movement or be PLACE within the Engagement Range of any enemy model.

When any model in a Unit is Engaged with any model in an Enemy Unit, they are considered Engaged.

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<< VISUAL: Roach and Zealot Within 1" of each other - Engaged >>

7.2.1 Engagement Restrictions

Models are Engaged only when all of the following conditions are met:

- Combat Tags match: Ground models Engage only Ground models. Flying models cannot be Engaged by any model.
- Terrain does not block:
- Size 0-1 terrain: Engagement is possible across it.
- Size 2+ terrain: Models cannot Engage through it. Even Within 1", a Size 2+ wall between them means they are not Engaged.
- Models on HIGH GROUND cannot Engage models on GROUND LEVEL, and vice versa.
- Models on MID GROUND can Engage models on HIGH GROUND or GROUND LEVEL only if both models are adjacent to the same ACCESS POINT connecting their respective elevations.

7.3 MARKERS AND TOKENS

7.3.1 Tokens

Tokens represent tangible battlefield assets - Creep Tumors, Corrosive Bile, and Shades. Treat them as **Terrain (Size 0)** with their own base. Models may move through Tokens, but **cannot** end movement overlapping them unless specified. Tokens are removed at the end of the Game Round unless stated otherwise. Always measure to the closest base edge of a Token.

7.3.2 Markers

Markers are used to keep track of **status** or game states. Unlike **Tokens**, they have no physical presence. They do not block **Line of Sight** or movement.

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- **Mission Markers** are numbered **Markers** used on the battlefield during Setup at coordinates shown on the **Deployment Card**. Each Marker is 32mm in diameter and has two sides: **Activated** or **Deactivated**. Each one is colour-coded by number: **Markers** 1 & 3 are Red, **Markers** 2 & 4 are Blue, and Marker 5 is Neutral.
- **Activation Markers** are set beside the Unit that has completed its turn in a Phase. They are double-sided with the arrow facing upwards, showing that the Unit has finished its turn in Phase 1 (Movement). The reverse side indicates that the Unit has completed its turn in Phase 2 (Assault).
- **Faction Indicators** are used on **Mission Markers** to show which player controls that Mission Marker at any moment. Some **Special Abilities** utilise Faction Indicators to mark an area of the battlefield.
- **Buff/Debuff Markers** are used to track effects and some statuses affecting the Unit. Positive effects are tracked with **Buff Markers** (Blue), and negative effects are tracked with **Debuff Markers** (Red).
- **Zone of Influence Markers** are used to define the **Zone of Influence** when the **Entry Edge** doesn't extend along the entire table edge. These are L-shaped corner **markers** that must be set exactly as shown on the **Deployment Card**.
- **First Player Marker** is used to track which player has initiative. The holder chooses which player activates first at the beginning of each Phase. The Marker passes between players throughout the game, usually when a player Passes early in a Phase or when Victory Points are tallied at the end of the Round.

7.4 DESTROYED UNITS

When the last model falls, the Unit is Destroyed.

Every effect, ability, and condition currently on the Destroyed Unit immediately ends. **Tokens** created by the destroyed Unit are removed (unless they are **STAY IN PLAY**). Effects that the Destroyed Unit applied to other **Units** remain on those **Units** unless the effect explicitly states otherwise.